



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Tyler
School Website: <https://www.tylerclassical.com/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy - Tyler (FCA Tyler) presents a clearly identified classical orientation, with core commitments to virtue, truth, beauty, and liberal-arts learning. Public materials emphasize formation of character, virtuous citizenship, and a classical curricular framing, along with a visible community/parent-partnership ethos (e.g., parent reading programs and family involvement). However, while FCA Tyler uses classical language and signals, several hallmark elements commonly associated with a robust classical program—such as explicit reference to the Great Books/Great Conversation, the grammar–logic–rhetoric trifecta, and explicit Socratic pedagogy across grade levels—are not consistently foregrounded in the public-facing materials. On balance, FCA Tyler leans toward a Classical orientation, but with meaningful gaps in explicit articulation of the full Classical School rubric.

Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- Religious/metaphysical foundations: Emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty and virtue, but does not foreground explicit theology, liturgical practice, or sacral rituals in public messaging. Expected to be strengthened with explicit theological framing or liturgical/community practices to reach a full Classical rating. Evidence points to a strong moral-philosophical orientation rather than a doctrinal program.
- Purpose and goal: Strong formation narrative; emphasis on forming virtuous citizens and human flourishing, not job-readiness. This strongly supports a Classical orientation.
- Curriculum: Uses “traditional liberal arts and sciences” language; explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books/Great Conversation are not consistently named in public content, tempering a full Classical rating.
- Pedagogy: Public materials do not consistently foreground Socratic seminars, scholé, or chant/memorization methods; thus, pedagogy is not fully aligned with the core Classical pedagogy rubric as presented in the Six Essential Elements.
- Faculty: Public messaging centers on leadership and partnership; explicit “living curriculum” or teacher-portrait constructs are not prominent, yielding a middling fit on this category.
- Parents & Community: Strong parent/teacher partnership signals (Reading At Home, parent resources, family involvement), aligning well with classical-community expectations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness; virtue/virtuous formation; strong moral framing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue) appear; explicit theology or liturgy not foregrounded. Negative indicators (secularism, relativism) not evidenced.

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- Positive signal dominates, but theology/liturgical practice are not clearly stated.
- Why this rating: Clear moral-truth-beauty orientation and virtue formation, but lacking explicit theological grounding or liturgical practice in public messaging.
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Formation of virtue and human flourishing as telos; formation over information; explicit aim to form virtuous citizens.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, liberal education (implicit), human flourishing, telos. Negative signals (workforce-oriented messaging) are not present in public materials.
 - Why this rating: Strong formation/virtue orientation and explicit rejection of a purely utilitarian job-prep framing align well with Classical aims.
 - Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public statements emphasize a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, trivium/quadrivium phrasing is not explicitly named in public text, and Great Books are not consistently foregrounded. The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and the canonical grammar-logic-rhetoric trio reduces the fit.
 - Why this rating: The curriculum language signals classical orientation (liberal arts), but lacks consistent explicit reference to the full canonical curriculum elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation).
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public-facing materials emphasize a traditional liberal-arts curriculum and “whole-group teaching methodology,” with no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé days, chanting, or memory-ritual pedagogy in the public content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive pedagogy terms in the classical lexicon (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization, chanting) are not visibly present in FCA Tyler’s public materials; absence counts as a negative signal for the pedagogy category.
 - Why this rating: The absence of explicit classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, scholé, chant/memory routines) places this category outside the Classical rubric as publicly evidenced.
 - Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Leadership (Headmaster) and staff emphasis noted; however, the public materials do not foreground a “living curriculum” portrait of teachers or a strongly stated faculty-formation role.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (model teachers, mentoring, living curriculum) are not explicitly present; there is some emphasis on faculty as role models implicitly through mission statements, but not explicit phrasing.
 - Why this rating: Some alignment with classical ideals via leadership emphasis and virtue orientation, but insufficient explicit articulation of faculty as “living curriculum” or portrait of teacher ideals.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Explicit parent involvement resources (Reading At Home; parent resources; empowerment of parents as co-educators) and open channels for family engagement.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, home-centered learning, and open campus. No clear negative signals observed in public materials.
 - Why this rating: Strong alignment with classical-community expectations through explicit parent partnership and family-facing resources.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit theological framing and liturgical/-community practices to public materials (even if non-sectarian in governance, a stated approach to reverence, contemplative life, or liturgical rhythms would raise alignment).
- Concrete steps: Publish a short, explicit statement tying virtue/truth/beauty to a theological/metaphysical framework and include at least one liturgical or communal practice described publicly.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Elevate explicit mention of the full classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books and Great Conversation) and Great-Books-based readings.

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- Concrete steps: Add a publicly accessible curriculum map detailing Trivium components (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium coverage, and a Great Books/GX list with sample units and a plan for “Great Conversation” style discussions across upper grades.
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Incorporate and publicly describe classical pedagogical methods (Socratic dialogue, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation).
 - Concrete steps: Publish a Pedagogy section that explains how Socratic seminars are used, how memory work and recitation are integrated, and how rest/pondering time (Scholé) is embedded in daily routines.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen and publicize a portrait of the faculty as the “living curriculum” and identify teacher-formation practices.
 - Concrete steps: Add a “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and “What a Classical Teacher Does” page, plus descriptions of ongoing teacher development in classical pedagogy.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Maintain and deepen public-facing parent-education content to reinforce the co-teacher model, possibly including structured parent book clubs, and more formal family-involvement programming.
 - Concrete steps: Publish a yearly calendar of parent-education events and book studies; provide summaries of parent-facing resources and measurable outcomes of parent involvement.

ABSTRACT

Founders Classical Academy - Tyler presents a publicly accessible Classical orientation: a strong virtue-formation narrative, liberal-arts curriculum framing, and explicit parent/community partnership. Category-by-category analysis shows strong Classical alignment in School Purpose & Goal and Parents & Community, with moderate alignment in Curriculum and Faculty, partial alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, and weaker alignment in Pedagogy. The aggregate rating is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting notable strengths but notable gaps in explicit reference to canonical Classical elements (Great Books/Great Conversation, grammar–logic–rhetoric, and Socratic pedagogy) and explicit theological or liturgical practices. Targeted enhancements—explicitly naming Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and Socratic pedagogy; clarifying theological or liturgical framing; and detailing the faculty living-curriculum model—would move FCA Tyler toward a full CLASSICAL designation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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